Keshav Singh was sent back to prison to serve out the last day of his sentence.

What was remarkable about this case is that the disagreements between the high court and the Uttar Pradesh Assembly would never have intensified in the way that they did had it not been for a series of mistakes and errors of judgement. It was curious enough that Singh's lawyer filed a petition with only one day left on his sentence. Had the government's advocate returned to the high court at 3 p.m. (as he had promised), he would have likely explained the circumstances to the court, and Singh's bail may have been denied at the outset. Instead, the high court benefited from only Singh's side of the story. Had the assembly responded by entering an appearance in court and apprising it of the full set of facts – rather than responding by passing a resolution in respect of Singh, Solomon and Justices Beg and Sehgal – the matter may have concluded there. Instead, institutions continued to respond defensively as the situation moved further along the ladder of escalation. This case is worth remembering – if for nothing else, to demonstrate how easily constitutional institutions can turn against one another and, equally, how difficult problems are best solved through statesmanship rather than brinksmanship.